

Log Reader Tool Documentation

Installation

1. Ensure your Appian version is up to date (24.2+ for MariaDB, 23.3+ for Oracle)
2. Run the database script that corresponds to your database (Oracle or MariaDB). **If you are upgrading from a version of the tool installed prior to July 2024, run the UPGRADE script only. If you are installing this tool for the first time, run the NEW script only.**
3. Ensure that the following plugins are installed in your environment
 - a. Log Reader
 - b. Add Documents to Zip
4. If you are installing into a highly available environment, update the LR_PROPERTIES file such that LR_HA = TRUE and LR_SERVERS equals a list of servers, separated by semicolons. If you are installing into a single-server environment, set LR_HA = FALSE and LR_SERVERS equal to the name of your server.
5. Install the application including the LR_PROPERTIES file. There are separate versions for Oracle and MariaDB. The properties file works for both versions.
6. Add administrator users to the LR Administrators group. These users will have access to all logs and can update log security settings.

Using the Log Reader Application

Appian Logs

From this tab, users can select a csv log file with a date range and add the file to a queue. For many logs, data more than 1 month old cannot be retrieved. If a log request is invalid, the "Add Log" button will be disabled with a tooltip explaining the issue.

Users can preview logs in Appian by clicking the "View" icon and download logs as csv individually by clicking the "Download" icon. If multiple logs are requested, users can also download all logs in the queue as a zip file by clicking "Prepare Zip" underneath the list of files. In a highly available environment, each log will download as a zip file with one log file per server.

The application supports the following csv logs out of the box:

login-audit.csv
logout-audit.csv
authz-audit.csv

audit/records_usage.csv
data-metrics/actions.csv
data-metrics/data-server.csv
data-metrics/system.csv
audit/task_errors.csv

Additional logs can be configured in the Admin Tools tab.

Tomcat Log

From this tab, users can read and download the Tomcat standard out log, returning up to 5,000 rows at a time. In a highly available environment, users must also select a server.

The application supports tomCat-stdOut.log by default. Additional logs can be configured in the Admin Tools tab.

Automations

From this tab, users in the LR Automation Users group can create automations which generate and store log files locally. Creating a new automation requires selecting a log file (only CSV and tomcat-stdOut logs supported), scheduling the first download date, and indicating how many days each file will include. The download will repeat on a cadence equal to the number of days per file, ensuring that all logs are captured by the automation. Automations should be used to satisfy log storage requirements. They may consume significant disk space if widely used without cleanup. Automations can be ended at any time, and the associated files will remain available.

Admin Tools

This tab allows Admin users to edit visibility settings and add new log files. From Visibility Settings, administrators can set group-level access to each log by clicking "Edit", adding groups to each row, and clicking "Save." All logs are available to the LR Administrators group by default. New groups can be created in the Appian Designer.

From the Add Log section, users can add to the set of available logs in the application. Not all logs are available via the Log Reader. Because the logs available are stored in a reference table, logs added will not transfer across environments automatically.

Technical Details

The Log Reader Application uses the Log Reader plugin to retrieve data from logs. When a log file is requested, an Appian process queries data using the Log Reader, builds the log file from the retrieved data, and returns the data to the interface. Access to log files is enforced by record-level security in Appian.